

Weekly Economic Commentary 13 April 2026

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 By Westpac New Zealand Economics

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Analysis and forecasts of the economy and markets, along with previews of data for the week ahead.



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A hawkish RBNZ is prepared to act decisively

Views on the likely duration and the severity of the war waxed and waned over the week as markets wavered between the prospect of an end to a civilisation (as mooted by President Trump) and the alternative of world peace in our time. The reality remains cloudy and the prospects of a long bumpy road ahead remain the base case. The RBNZ channelled these themes of uncertainty and the prospect of potentially longer-lived inflationary impacts, by delivering a hawkish hold. We brought forward our view of when the OCR will begin to normalise and have further fine-tuned how the overall tightening cycle may evolve.

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